

The Rate Race

AUGUST 10, 2009

As channels scramble in an ever-crowded market, explicit reality shows and a new genre of girl-in-peril soaps compete for viewers' short attention span.



“Mindless imitation of programmes from an alien cultural context is a gamble that succeeds much less often than it fails. Television channels should rather focus on innovation and creativity.”

M.H. RAO, *Hyderabad*

Racing Ahead

The debate on controlling television content is twisted by raising the question—who is the government to decide what the people should see (“The Rate Race”, August 10)? The actual issue is what the visual media should or shouldn’t show. If the Censor Board can look into films and decide the legal limit for depiction of violence, obscenity and other such content which may offend the sensibilities of the audience, then why can the same not be done for television broadcasts as well?

M.C. JOSHI,

via www.indiatoday.in

The rat race for higher TRPs is nothing unusual, but this is the first time that the channels are coming up with different



Peace in Pieces

Be it the nuclear deal with the US or the latest Indo-Pak joint statement, each and every diplomatic action taken by Prime Minister Manmohan Singh forces us to think that he is either naive or working under someone’s pressure (“Buying Peace”, August 10). History will remember him as a political leader who became prime minister because of Sonia Gandhi, who, in turn, will emerge as the most powerful leader without any post and responsibility.

DEVENDRA NARAIN, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Ground realities show that the Pakistani establishment has not deviated from its template of active antipathy towards India. Debate on the rights and wrongs of the joint statement should now end and the nation should back the prime minister who is in pursuit of designer peace with our neighbour.

BISHAN SAHAI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

topics, content and formats to create an interest among the viewers. The only caution, however, to be exercised is that the viewers should not be left with a bitter taste while being served something different or spicy.

KAUSHAL KISHORE, *Indore*

Last Man Standing

By offering to resign, Omar Abdullah has played the biggest gamble of his career (“Valley of Sleaze”, August 10). If he can come out unscathed, he would succeed in raising the bar for other politicians. However, should any skeleton tumble out or dirty tricks manage to make the mud stick, it will be difficult for Abdullah to recover.

J. SESHAGIRI,

via www.indiatoday.in

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301.
Phones: 2479900 from Noida, 95120-2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad, and 0120-2479900 from Rest of India.
Toll Free No.: 1800 1800 100. Fax: 0120-4078080. E-mail: wecare@intoday.com